

TOPIC 3: READING AND COMPREHENSION

1. Scanning

Scanning is reading quickly to find specific information (a name, date, number). Move your eyes rapidly over the text until you locate what you need.

2. Skimming

Skimming is reading quickly for the general idea or main points. Read titles, first sentences of paragraphs and keywords.

3. Referencing Skills

Use pronouns and other reference words to track who or what is being discussed. Look back in the text to confirm antecedents.

4. Making Deductions

Deductions are conclusions based on evidence in the passage, not only on words stated directly. Support your answer with clues from the text.

5. Topic Sentences

A topic sentence often states the main idea of a paragraph (frequently at the beginning). Identifying it helps you summarise and answer “main idea” questions.

6. Summary

Practise scanning, skimming, referencing, deduction and finding topic sentences to improve comprehension speed and accuracy.

End of Topic 3